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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: PARENTING TWINS: A PHENOMENOLOGICAL STUDY OF THE LIVED EXPERIENCE OF COUPLES WITH TWIN CHILDREN	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader/s:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☐ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center							
(4) Site of implementation									
		Municipality/City:	All Municipalities						
		Province:	Capiz						
		Region:	VI						
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization								

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(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization
(9) Rationale (State the research problem and significance of the project to the current needs of the country. The proposal should justify resource expenditure. A typical justification would include a brief introduction, a general statement concerning the historical basis for R & D and, thrusts being addressed, utilization of the expected output and the impact information generated will have on science, the target users and the country.) Rationale Parenting is the process of growing children and providing them with safety and care so that they can grow up to be healthy adults (Kretchmar-Hendricks, 2017). Parents are expected to provide the needs of their children from physical, emotional, cognitive, to spiritual needs. The child's development relies mostly on the quality of care and nurturance that they receive from their parents and guardians. Thus, parenting plays an essential role in the child's growth and development. To be a parent is never an easy task since raising a child to become a mature individual involves a complex interaction of nature and nurture. Aside from genetic and physiological make-up, parents develop characteristics of their children through their behavior and the social climate that is being provided for them. This demands much of the parents' abilities and resources. They sacrifice their lives and their whole being in order to provide the best for their children. Moreover, this role is assumed to be more complicated when parenting multiple birth children such as twins. Having twins in the family is a rare phenomenon. In fact there are only less than 15 in every 1000 live births in the country (Khan and Pedersen, 2016). With this, families get excited when expecting twin children. However, it is notable that there are a lot of considerations in having multiple birth children such as high-risk in pregnancy and childbirth, and higher demand in caregiving and parenting. Multiple births are associated with substantial medical, health care, socio-emotional, developmental, educational and economic consequences for both families and society (Mönkediek, Schulz, Eichhorn, and Diewald, 2020). In addition, Wenzel, Battle, and Tezanos (2015) reported that parents of multiples experience heightened symptoms of depression, anxiety, and parenting stress. This may be because the life world of multiple birth parents is characterized by a state of constant vigilance and ensuring that children continue to cope (Heinonen, et.al., 2016). Leonard and Denton (2006) further reveal that four interrelated principles of good practice are vital to the care of multiple birth families namely the involvement of a range of disciplines, of the family and of the multiple birth community; the provision of specialized care; coordinated services; and the building of family competency including the capacity to make informed decisions. Additionally, Wenzel, Battle, and Tezanos (2015) reported the need for novel intervention strategies to meet the needs of this growing population. The literatures reviewed reveal that parenting twins is challenging and that support and specialized care needs to be provided for them. Thus, there is a need to conduct a qualitative study in order to explore and understand the lived experience of parents of twin children so that relevant services and programs may be developed and provided for these families.	
(9-A) Project Description (Discuss the project strategy and plan of action of the project. It should also describe the technical procedures and other works needed to carry out the project objectives. The relationship of the project inputs and activities should be explained clearly in this section. Projects similar/related to the proposed project should be mentioned.)	

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(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem (for Social Sciences) (Statement of the specific purpose to address the problem areas of the project.)

Statement of the Problem

The purpose of the study is to understand the lived experience of couples in parenting twin children. Specifically, the study will answer the following research questions:

1. What are the experiences of parents in simultaneously providing the physiological and psychological needs to their twin children?
2. What challenges and successes do parents encounter in training and disciplining their twin children?
3. What are their practices in dealing with squabbling and competition between their twin children?
4. What are their perceptions about their children's individual identity?

(11) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.)

The study is anchored on the Attachment Theory and Parenting Styles Theory. The Attachment Theory, developed by Bowlby and Ainsworth, proposes that the relationship between a parent and infant reflects a behavioral system that has adapted to promote survival and competent functioning of the offspring (Bretherton, 1992). This means that the parent's behavior towards the child greatly affects the development of the child's abilities as well as attitude. According to Ainsworth there are three major attachment styles in children namely secured attachment, ambivalent attachment, and avoidant attachment. These styles are developed based on the quality of care that they receive from their parents or caregivers. Moreover, the Parenting Styles Theory by D. Baumrind posits that there are four different parenting styles namely authoritative, permissive, uninvolved, and authoritarian (Kuppens & Ceulemans, 2019). These styles differ in the parent's way of providing warmth and nurturance, discipline, communication, and expectation of maturity. These parenting styles are understood to affect the child's growth and ability to thrive especially on their social, emotional, and cognitive functioning.

Based on the Attachment Theory and Parenting Styles Theory, it is assumed that the parents' behavior, the way they teach and discipline, and the way they provide their children's needs are essential to the development of their children. When parents are warm, engaged, sensitive and responsive to their children's needs, and help them understand and efficiently cope with their emotions, they seem to do well with their life. Furthermore, parents must also keep in mind the unique characteristics of their children, such as being a child with a twin sibling. Parenting twins would mean providing these to two children of the same age at the same time. Thus, the parents of twin children are challenged to be more creative and to be more dedicated to simultaneously, if not equally provide these to their children.

(12) Review of Literature/Prior Art Search (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of – the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

Review of Related Literature

Several studies on parenting multiple birth children were reviewed and they revealed that having multiple birth children caused challenges of various types. Mönkediek, Schulz, Eichhorn, and Diwald (2020) reported that multiple births are associated with substantial medical, health care, socio-emotional, developmental, educational and economic consequences for both families and society. In addition, Wenzel, Battle, and Tezanos (2015) reported that parents of multiples experience heightened symptoms of depression, anxiety, and parenting stress. This may be because the life world of multiple birth parents is characterized by a state of constant vigilance and ensuring that children continue to cope (Heinonen, et.al., 2016).

With this, practical help and intervention may be developed and provided for these parents. Leonard and Denton (2006) reveal that four interrelated principles of good practice are vital to the care of

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multiple birth families namely the involvement of a range of disciplines, of the family and of the multiple birth community; the provision of specialized care; coordinated services; and the building of family competency including the capacity to make informed decisions. Additionally, Wenzel, Battle, and Tezanos (2015) reported the need for novel intervention strategies to meet the needs of this growing population.

This literature review shows that there are challenges in parenting twins and that interventions and specialized support may be provided for this special population

(13) Methodology (Details such as; a) variables to be measured and evaluated; b) treatments to be used and their layout; c) experimental procedures and design; d) statistical analysis; e) evaluation method and observations to be made, strategies for implementation.)

Methodology

SETTING AND/OR CONTEXT OF THE STUDY

This study will utilize the Interpretive Phenomenological Analysis in understanding the lived experiences of couples in parenting their twin children. This approach aims to examine the participants' interpretation of their experience with the purpose of gaining understanding and presenting the researcher's interpretation of the participants' understanding of their experience (Smith, Flowers & Larkin, 2012). In this approach, the study will be conducted with the participants who are treated with worth and dignity as researchers get into their objective reality and draw knowledge from their lived experience. This study is guided by the Constructivist epistemological stance. Constructivism posits that knowledge is socially constructed, made, and interpretive categories are prior to facts. Knowledge provides constructs or frameworks by which people make sense of their experience (Olssen, 1995). Moreover, the interpretivist approach directs the research to gain in-depth insight into the lives of the respondents, to gain an empathic understanding why they act in the way they do.

Moreover, since researches reveal that parenting twins is associated with more demands for the parents, this study will be conducted to explore the lived experience of the couples in parenting for their twin children specifically in providing for their needs, training and disciplining them. Through understanding their experiences, a more concrete and specialized assistance can be provided for them.

PARTICIPANTS OF THE STUDY

The participants of the study will be Filipino couples with twin children aged 19 years old and below. Twelve (12) couples will be invited to participate in the study through written communication. Purposive sampling will be employed to ensure that participants possess the criteria for the study. Alasev (2017) emphasized that in a phenomenological research tradition, the size of the participants can be between two and 25. The selection of these participants should reflect and represent the homogeneity that exists among the participants' sample pool in order to get a better gauge and a better understanding of the overall perceptions among the participants' lived experiences.

PROCEDURE OF THE STUDY

The participants' lived experience on parenting twins will be gathered using in-depth interviews. After identifying participants using random sampling, an informed consent will be sought to confirm their willingness to participate in the study. One interview session will be scheduled per participant. However, additional interview sessions will be conducted if follow-up interviews are needed. The interviews will be done for sixty to ninety minutes per session at the participants' preferred time and venue. Video recording will be done after seeking full consent and approval from the participants. Research notes will also be maintained to jot down important observations as the interviews progress. The data will then be coded and analyzed.

Bracketing will be employed to set aside the researcher's personal experience, biases, and preconceived notions about the research topic. This will be done by writing memos throughout the data collection and analysis. Through this, the researcher can examine and reflect upon one's engagement with the data in order to allow the data to speak for itself. Moreover, several validity check methods will be

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performed in the study. First, the participants will be asked to check if the finding of the study is valid for them since it is their experience that is being explored and studied. Second, the findings will be checked against current literature. Third, the study will be evaluated by the research committee of the institution. This brings in certain objective or trans subjective agreement.

DATA SOURCE

The data will be coming from the interview transcripts. The in-depth interviews will be recorded using the audio and video recording device. In addition, field notes will also be maintained by the researcher. This will include the observational notes, theoretical notes, methodological notes, and analytical memos.

DATA ANALYSIS

The explication of the data will be guided by Hycner's (1999) Explication Process. The term analysis is avoided because it usually means breaking into parts and explication implies investigation of the constituents of a phenomenon while keeping the context of the whole. Since phenomenology is concerned with the essence of an experience from the perspective of the participant, keeping the whole in tack should not be easily dismissed as trivial to the process. The explication will be done by following the given steps. First, bracketing and phenomenological reduction. Second, delineating units of meaning. Third, clustering units of meaning to form themes. Fourth, summarizing, validating and modifying (if necessary) each interview. Fifth, extracting general and unique themes from all the interviews and making a composite summary.

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use gantt chart. Below is an example. This can be modified base on your desired Work plan.)

Activities	July 2022	August 2022	November - December 2022	January – February 2023	March - May 2023	June – July 2023
Proposal/ Presentation						
Preparation of manuscript and Instrument						
Gathering of Data						
Data Encoding						
Interpretation of Data						
Presentation of Completed Research						

(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)

Brochures on the lived experiences of parents of twin children
Extension program to provide support to parents with twin children

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Design (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services to be transferred as extension activities)

(16) Targets Beneficiaries (Who the clientele are and what are the expected outcome/effects of the use of the projects output)

Parents with multiple birth children

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(17) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role (Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours):

Program/Project Members (in hours):

(18) Budgetary Requirement

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	Quantity	Amount (PhP)
A. Personnel Services (For studies needed the Research Assistant, informant/s, guide)	1	33000
B. Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE) (modify and include only whichever is applicable)		
- Transportation allowance		5000
- Meal allowance during data gathering		5000
- Professional fees (laboratory analysis and other related fees)		
- Miscellaneous (for incidental expenses)		1000
- Printing		1000
C. CAPITAL OUTLAY		
Total		45000

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

- Bastian Mönkediek, Wiebke Schulz, Harald Eichhorn, Martin Diewald (2020). Is there something special about twin families? A comparison of parenting styles in twin and non-twin families. Social Science Research, 90, 102-441. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssresearch.2020.102441>.
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- Wenze, S. J., Battle, C. L., & Tezanos, K. M. (2015). Raising multiples: mental health of mothers and fathers in early parenthood. Archives of women's mental health, 18(2), 163–176.

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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Educational Background

- Doctorate Degree : Doctor of Philosophy in Education Major in Psychology and Guidance (on going)
West Visayas State University
- Master's Degree : Master of Science in Guidance and Counseling
Central Philippine University ; June 2007 – October 2011
- Bachelor's Degree : Bachelor of Arts in Psychology (Cum Laude)
Central Philippine University ; June 2003 – March 2007

Work Experience

- **Faculty** March 2017 – Present
CAPIZ STATE UNIVERSITY – SIGMA SATELLITE COLLEGE
- **Guidance Counselor** June 2013 – February 2017
CAPIZ STATE UNIVERSITY – SIGMA SATELLITE COLLEGE
- **College Instructor** November 2008 – March 2013
COLLEGE OF ST. JOHN – ROXAS

Affiliations:

- Philippine Guidance and Counseling Association (PGCA)
- Guidance Counselors Network – Capiz Chapter